Kelly Vohs

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Operator and CEO. Built and led organizations from a single property to **175,000 apartments** and **$4B in revenue**. **12 years leading Blackstone portfolio companies** – making capital allocation decisions at scale, building shared services platforms that balance central capability with local autonomy, and growing guest-centered cultures across hundreds of distributed sites. Former **Green Beret** with four combat deployments. 29 years of leadership across hospitality, multifamily real estate, technology, and the U.S. military. I believe in an order of operations: **people, product, performance**. Get the team right and the rest follows.

EXPERIENCE

CEO, SafetyCulture — 2025–2026

Global SaaS platform for frontline operations – 25,000 customers in 180+ countries, including IKEA, Royal Caribbean, Toyota, and SpaceX. Hired as President to lead go-to-market and customer strategy from the U.S. The founder stepped down two months before my start; I took over as CEO. Inherited a platform that needed a full rebuild and a team spread across Sydney, Manila, Manchester, Amsterdam, and Kansas City. Rebuilt the executive team – attracted senior leaders from Google, Twitter, Okta, and Microsoft to Sydney. Reset the product roadmap and go-to-market motion and grew **ARR from $165M to $217M**. Stepped away when the role required permanent relocation to Sydney – family comes first, a lesson the army taught me a long time ago.

CEO, LivCor (Blackstone) — 2020–2025

Blackstone's national multifamily platform. Asked to take this on in August 2020 while still running Beam Living. Ran both companies simultaneously through COVID, then brought them together with LivCor as the parent platform. Grew from **40,000 to 175,000 apartments**. **$4B in revenue**. Acquired Preferred Apartment Communities and hired CEOs for both Beam and PAC underneath.

Massive, fast, and demanding. Onboarding **50,000 units a year**. Demanding investors. COVID. Hundreds of distributed communities, each with its own team and identity. Built the shared services model – revenue management, technology, capital planning – while making sure local teams kept their autonomy and their voice.

Created the **"Good Neighbors"** operating culture: kind, helpful, thoughtful, respectful. **Zero evictions during COVID for two years**.

COO → CEO, Beam Living (Blackstone) — 2017–2022

StuyTown – the largest rental community in the country. 11,241 apartments. A city within a city. Transformed it into Beam Living and grew the platform to 15,000 apartments across New York. **$600M revenue**. Over **$300M invested in capital improvements**. Expense growth **CAGR of just over 2%** across six years. Took work order completion from **three weeks to an average of five days**. Reshaped 120,000 sq ft of retail – rents from **$65–70 a foot to over $155**, anchored by Whole Foods and new restaurant concepts that reshaped the community and drove residential demand. During COVID, built a community pantry, raised money, and delivered over **one million pounds of food** to New Yorkers in need.

General Manager, Hilton Hotels (Blackstone) — 2013–2017

Boca Raton Resort & Club: two hotels, 1,047 rooms, two golf courses, 14 restaurants, 200,000 sq ft of meeting space, and a 3,200-family membership program. Changed the culture of an 1,800-person organization – **91% team morale**, **#1 leadership index score** across Hilton for properties with 450+ respondents. **50% increase in EBITDA in 24 months**. This is where **Better Today Than Yesterday** was born – 39 days in, staring at 67 projects on a whiteboard, and deciding to get 1% better every day and let it compound. Relocated to Chicago to build and open the Conrad – adaptive reuse, first employee, $140M project, grew the team from **1 to 250**. Also ran the Waldorf Astoria Chicago.

VP Operations, BR Guest Hospitality (Starwood) — 2011–2013

Starwood portfolio company. 22 restaurants across six brands and 3,000 employees in New York City. First role after eight years in the army. Built the people process from scratch – analytical hiring, 30/60/90 reviews, performance management. **Doubled EBITDA**, most profitable year in company history. Zagat scores **up 22 points** across 17 NYC units.

U.S. Army – Green Beret — 2003–2011

Enlisted at 26, two weeks after the invasion of Iraq. Special Forces pipeline (18X), specializing in unconventional warfare. Learned Arabic. Earned the Green Beret after two years of selection and training. Specialized in human intelligence. Reached Sergeant First Class in under eight years. Four combat deployments to Iraq and Central Asia. Worked alongside CIA, State Department, and embassy teams in Baghdad, Kurdistan, Tajikistan, and Afghanistan. Awarded the **Bronze Star Medal** and the **Defense Meritorious Service Medal**. Led humanitarian relief operations in Tajikistan – landed U.S. aircraft on a remote airfield 48 hours after meeting with the Deputy Prime Minister, provided assistance to **8,000 displaced persons**. Earned an MBA (University of Colorado) while deployed.

The Breakers of Palm Beach

1996–2003

Walked in as a server at 18. Earned a degree in accounting while working full-time, finishing second in class. Almost fired twice for putting process before people. The leaders there taught me it's about team. That's where **people, product, performance** started. In that order. Built L'Escalier restaurant from the ground up and won the **AAA Five Diamond Award** – one of 51 in the country. Left as Rooms Division Manager. I've carried their lessons with me for more than two decades.

EDUCATION

MBA, Management – University of Colorado

BBA, Accounting, Salutatorian – Northwood University

Special Forces Qualification Course, Honor Graduate – JFK Special Warfare Center & School

Modern Standard Arabic – JFK Special Warfare Center & School

PERSONAL

Married to Brandi. Three sons – 21, 19, 15. Based in New York City. I run, take photos, build software, and write about trying to get better. Brandi is my adventure partner. And that's what we do. Boys, three dogs, a tortoise, and a cat in tow.

– Kelly